SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #41 · GOD'S PROVISION

“If God loved me, I wouldn't be struggling.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When money runs short, it is natural to wonder where God is. Many of us were taught, openly or quietly, that love and ease go together: good children are cared for, and loved people are comfortable. Hardship then feels like a message about how God sees us. Add a hard childhood, a loss, or a prayer that seemed unanswered, and the conclusion “He must not love me” can feel like the only explanation.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture never ties God’s love to a smooth life. Jesus said plainly, “In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!” Paul says that nothing in all creation can separate us from the love of God in Christ Jesus. He also teaches that suffering produces perseverance, character, and hope, and that God has poured out His love into our hearts. The cross, where struggle and love met, is the proof of His love, not the absence of struggle.

> *“For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord”* (Romans 8:38–39).

Also see

> “I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!” (John 16:33).

> “Not only that, but we also rejoice in our sufferings, because we know that suffering produces perseverance; perseverance, character; and character, hope. And hope does not disappoint us, because God has poured out His love into our hearts through the Holy Spirit, whom He has given us” (Romans 5:3–5).

> “But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us” (Romans 5:8).

> “Consider it pure joy, my brothers, when you encounter trials of many kinds, because you know that the testing of your faith develops perseverance” (James 1:2–3).

Common self-statements

- God must be angry with me.
- Other people are not struggling like this, so God must love them more.
- If God cared, He would fix this.
- Maybe God does not love me the way He loves others.
- I must have done something to lose His love.
- My hardship proves I am not loved.

Common logical errors

- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unloved and concluding that I am.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know how God feels about me from my circumstances.
- Overgeneralizing: Letting one hard season define God’s whole character.
- Social comparison: Believing others are loved more because they struggle less.

Challenging questions

- What did I learn growing up about the link between love and comfort?
- Did Jesus, whom the Father loved, go through hardship? What does that tell me?
- What does Scripture say can separate me from God's love?
- Where have I seen God's care even in this hard season?
- What evidence of God's love do I have that does not depend on my bank account?
- What would I say to a friend who believed this?

Truth summary

> God's love for me is proven by Christ's death for me, not by my circumstances. I can struggle and be deeply loved at the same time. Nothing, including a hard season with money, can separate me from His love.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- God, All Loving
- Love, By God
- Hardship
- Suffering
- Troubles

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Suffering
- Trouble/Hardship

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If God loved me, I wouldn't be struggling"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If God loved me, I wouldn't be struggling." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did I learn about love and comfort?
- ☐ What does Romans 8 say can separate me from God's love?
- ☐ Where has God cared for me lately?
- ☐ What did Jesus' own life show about love and struggle?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ What do I need to tell God honestly?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God's love is not measured by my comfort.
- ☐ Nothing can separate me from His love.
- ☐ Christ proved His love while I was still a sinner.
- ☐ Hardship can grow perseverance, character, and hope.
- ☐ Jesus overcame the world.
- ☐ I am loved in the middle of this.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Romans 8:38–39**
  "For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord."
- ☐ **John 16:33**
  "I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!"
- ☐ **Romans 5:8**
  "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Signs of His love: Each day, write one sign of God's love that has nothing to do with money, such as a person, a verse, or a moment of peace.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 8:38–39 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Nothing can separate me from God's love, even this hard season.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "God, All Loving" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Write the link you were taught. Describe what you learned about love and comfort and who taught it.
- [ ] Read Romans 8:35–39 slowly. Underline each thing that cannot separate you from God's love.
- [ ] List signs of care. Write five ways God has cared for you in this season.
- [ ] Tell God honestly. Pray what you feel, including the hurt, and then ask Him to show His love.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If God loved me, I wouldn't be struggling": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A sign of His love
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If God loved me, I wouldn't be struggling.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, this season is hard and I have wondered whether You love me. Show me again that nothing can separate me from Your love in Christ. Hold me in this, and open my eyes to Your care. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #42 · GOD'S PROVISION

“God has forgotten my needs.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When prayers about rent, bills, or work seem to go unanswered, silence can feel like neglect. People who were overlooked as children, whose needs were forgotten by caregivers, often carry the same expectation toward God. The longer the need lasts, the more natural it feels to say, “He has forgotten me.”

What Scripture teaches

God anticipated this fear. Through Isaiah He asks, “Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you! Behold, I have inscribed you on the palms of My hands.” Jesus tells us that not one sparrow is forgotten by God and that we are worth more than many sparrows. He says our heavenly Father knows that we need these things. Paul promises that God will supply all our needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus. Waiting is not forgetting.

> *“‘Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you! Behold, I have inscribed you on the palms of My hands; your walls are ever before Me.’”* (Isaiah 49:15–16).

Also see

> “For the Gentiles strive after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them” (Matthew 6:32).

> “Are not five sparrows sold for two pennies? Yet not one of them is forgotten by God. And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows” (Luke 12:6–7).

> “And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus” (Philippians 4:19).

> “But I am poor and needy; may the Lord think of me. You are my helper and deliverer; O my God, do not delay” (Psalm 40:17).

Common self-statements

- God has overlooked me.
- He answers everyone else’s prayers but mine.
- My needs are too small or too ordinary for Him.
- I have been waiting too long.
- He has moved on from my situation.
- No one is looking out for me, not even God.

Common logical errors

- Emotional reasoning: Feeling forgotten and concluding that I am.
- Jumping to conclusions: Treating a delay as a refusal.
- Selective attention: Noticing the unmet need and missing past provision.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that God will never come through.

Challenging questions

- When have I been overlooked by people, and how has that colored how I see God?
- What provision, large or small, have I received that I did not earn?
- Is waiting the same thing as being forgotten?
- What does God say about forgetting His children?
- What needs of mine has God already met?
- What am I asking Him for, and what can I do while I wait?

Truth summary

> God has not forgotten me. He has written my name on the palms of His hands. He knows what I need before I ask. Waiting is hard, but it is not abandonment, and I can keep trusting Him and taking sensible steps.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- God, All Knowing
- Protection
- Trust
- Help
- Poverty

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Money/Riches
- Trouble/Hardship

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "God has forgotten my needs"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"God has forgotten my needs." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When have I felt overlooked by people?
- ☐ What has God already provided?
- ☐ What needs am I bringing to Him?
- ☐ Is waiting the same as forgetting?
- ☐ Who could help me with one need?
- ☐ What can I do while I wait?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God cannot forget me.
- ☐ My name is on His palms.
- ☐ The Father knows what I need.
- ☐ He cares for the sparrows, and I am worth more.
- ☐ God will supply my needs.
- ☐ Waiting is not forgetting.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Isaiah 49:15–16**
  "'Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you! Behold, I have inscribed you on the palms of My hands; your walls are ever before Me.'"
- ☐ **Matthew 6:32**
  "For the Gentiles strive after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them."
- ☐ **Philippians 4:19**
  "And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Provision seen: Each day, write one thing you received that you did not earn or arrange: food, kindness, a door opening.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Isaiah 49:15–16 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God has written my name on the palms of His hands, so He has not forgotten me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "God, All Knowing" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] List past provision. Write ten times God or His people met a need of yours.
- [ ] Name the needs. Write each need plainly and tell God about each one.
- [ ] Ask someone. Tell a trusted friend or church member about one need and let them help.
- [ ] Read Isaiah 49:15–16. Read it aloud each morning for a week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "God has forgotten my needs": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Provision noticed
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~God has forgotten my needs.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel forgotten. Thank You that You say You cannot forget me. Show me how You have already provided, supply what I need, and give me patience while I wait. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #43 · GOD'S PROVISION

“My money problems are God's punishment.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When something goes wrong after a mistake, such as a bad purchase, a debt, or a time we cut corners, it is easy to connect the dots and decide God is paying us back. Some families and churches taught that bad things happen to bad people. Guilt over past sins can make financial trouble feel like a verdict.

What Scripture teaches

For those in Christ Jesus, Scripture says, “there is now no condemnation.” The psalmist says that God “has not dealt with us according to our sins or repaid us according to our iniquities.” In Christ we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of our trespasses. When the disciples asked whose sin caused a man’s suffering, Jesus said that neither he nor his parents sinned. Sometimes our choices have natural consequences, which we can learn from and repair, but consequences are not God’s punishment. Christ already bore the punishment.

> *“Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus”* (Romans 8:1).

Also see

> “He has not dealt with us according to our sins or repaid us according to our iniquities” (Psalm 103:10).

> “In Him we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of our trespasses, according to the riches of His grace” (Ephesians 1:7).

> “Jesus answered, ‘Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him.’” (John 9:3).

> “For the Lord disciplines the one He loves, and He chastises every son He receives” (Hebrews 12:6).

Common self-statements

- God is making me pay for my mistakes.
- I deserve this.
- This is what I get for what I did.
- God is teaching me a lesson by taking things away.
- If I had been better, this would not have happened.
- I am being punished.

Common logical errors

- Personalization: Assuming every bad event is about me.
- Magical thinking: Believing that sins and money events are directly connected.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty and concluding that I am being punished.
- Overgeneralizing: Treating one mistake as the cause of everything.

Challenging questions

- What exactly do I believe I am being punished for?
- Have I confessed it to God? What does Scripture say He does with confessed sin?

- Are there natural consequences here that I can learn from, without calling them punishment?
- Do good people ever have money trouble? What does that tell me?
- What does “no condemnation” mean for me?
- What is one practical step I can take to repair what I can?

Truth summary

> There is now no condemnation for me in Christ Jesus. Some of my choices have consequences I can learn from and repair, but God is not punishing me. He forgave me, and He is with me in the repair.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Guilt/Shame
- Forgiveness
- Sin, Consequences of
- Confession
- Grace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Money/Riches

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Forgiveness — Matthew West
Ask God for help releasing resentment while working through real hurt.

Clean — Natalie Grant
God’s cleansing grace challenges the belief that shame or sin makes a person beyond restoration.

This Is Amazing Grace — Phil Wickham
Christ bears the burden of rescue rather than demanding self-salvation.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My money problems are God's punishment"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My money problems are God's punishment." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I think I am being punished for?
- ☐ Have I confessed it?
- ☐ What are the natural consequences?
- ☐ What does "no condemnation" mean?
- ☐ What can I repair?
- ☐ Who could help me repair it?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ There is no condemnation in Christ.
- ☐ God has not repaid me according to my sins.
- ☐ I am forgiven through His blood.
- ☐ Consequences are not condemnation.
- ☐ Good people have money trouble too.
- ☐ God helps me repair what I can.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 8:1
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Psalm 103:10
  "He has not dealt with us according to our sins or repaid us according to our iniquities."
- ☐ Ephesians 1:7
  "In Him we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of our trespasses, according to the riches of His grace."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Consequence or condemnation?: Each time you think "I am being punished," write the fact, the lesson, and one step of repair.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 8:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "There is no condemnation for me in Christ, so this is not God's punishment.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Forgiveness" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ Name it. Write exactly what you feel guilty about and bring it to God in prayer.
- ☐ Separate consequence from punishment. List the natural results of your choices and one lesson each.
- ☐ Plan a repair. Write one practical step, such as a call, a budget, or an apology.
- ☐ Say Romans 8:1 aloud. Say it whenever condemnation rises.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My money problems are God's punishment": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Condemnation answered
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My money problems are God's punishment.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I have been afraid that You are punishing me. Thank You that in Christ there is no condemnation. Forgive me where I have failed, teach me what I need to learn, and help me repair what I can. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #44 · GOD'S PROVISION

“It's all up to me; I can't count on God to provide.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

People who grew up with unreliable adults often learn to rely only on themselves. A parent who lost jobs, a family that ran out of money, or a time when no one came to help can train a person to carry every burden alone. Some of us were also taught, “God helps those who help themselves,” which is not in the Bible, and which leaves us believing that provision rests on us.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does call us to work, and God often provides through our work. But it also says, “Commit your way to the LORD; trust in Him, and He will do it.” “Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding.” “Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you.” Jesus says to seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be added to us. We do our part, and God is the Provider behind it all.

> *“Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight”* (Proverbs 3:5–6).

Also see

> “Commit your way to the LORD; trust in Him, and He will do it” (Psalm 37:5).

> “Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken” (Psalm 55:22).

> “But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be added unto you” (Matthew 6:33).

> “And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus” (Philippians 4:19).

Common self-statements

- If I do not handle it, no one will.
- I cannot rely on anyone, including God.
- God helps those who help themselves.
- Trusting God is irresponsible.
- I have to make it happen.
- Rest is a luxury I cannot afford.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing it is either all me or all God.
- Overgeneralizing: Assuming God is as unreliable as people who let me down.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should carry everything.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining collapse if I let go for a moment.

Challenging questions

- Who let me down in the past, and how have I carried that over to God?
- Where did I get the idea that “God helps those who help themselves”?

- What have I already received that I did not produce myself?
- What would it look like to do my part and trust God with the rest?
- What burden can I give to God today?
- Where has God come through for me before?

Truth summary

> I can work hard and still depend on God. He is the Provider behind my work, and He invites me to cast my burdens on Him. I do my part, and I trust Him with what I cannot control.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- God, All Powerful
- Will of God
- Plans
- Refuge/Safety

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Money/Riches
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "It's all up to me; I can't count on God to provide"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"It's all up to me; I can't count on God to provide." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who let me down in the past?
- ☐ What is mine to do?
- ☐ What is only God's to do?
- ☐ Where has God come through?
- ☐ What burden can I give Him?
- ☐ How can I rest?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is my Provider.
- ☐ I can do my part and trust Him with the rest.
- ☐ He will sustain me.
- ☐ I do not have to carry it all.
- ☐ Trusting God is wise.
- ☐ He has come through before.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 3:5–6
  "Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight."
- ☐ Psalm 37:5
  "Commit your way to the LORD; trust in Him, and He will do it."
- ☐ Psalm 55:22
  "Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ My part and His part: Each day, write one thing you will do and one thing you will hand to God.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 55:22 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will cast my burden on the Lord and He will sustain me.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ Make two columns. List what is yours to do and what only God can do.
- ☐ List past provision. Write five times God came through when you could not.
- ☐ Hand over one burden. Pray Psalm 55:22 and name the burden aloud.
- ☐ Rest on purpose. Take a real break and notice that God still holds things together.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "It's all up to me; I can't count on God to provide": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A burden handed over
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~It's all up to me; I can't count on God to provide.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have tried to carry everything. Teach me to work faithfully and to trust You as my Provider. I cast my burdens on You today. Sustain me and my family. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #45 · GOD'S PROVISION

“Worrying about money shows I'm being responsible.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Worry can feel like a form of caring. If we stop worrying, we fear we will stop paying attention. Parents who fretted about money may have modeled it as the mark of a serious person, and sometimes worry did seem to get things done. Over time, the habit can become automatic and exhausting.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus asks, “Who of you by worrying can add a single hour to his life?” and tells us, “Do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself.” Paul says, “Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.” Peter says, “Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you.” Responsibility is planning, budgeting, and acting. Worry does none of these.

> *“Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus”* (Philippians 4:6–7).

Also see

> “Who of you by worrying can add a single hour to his life?” (Matthew 6:27).

> “Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own” (Matthew 6:34).

> “Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you” (1 Peter 5:7).

> “The plans of the diligent bring plenty, as surely as haste leads to poverty” (Proverbs 21:5).

Common self-statements

- If I stop worrying, I will get careless.
- Worrying keeps me prepared.
- Good providers lose sleep over money.
- Relaxing about money is irresponsible.
- I have to think about it constantly.
- Worry shows I care.

Common logical errors

- Magical thinking: Believing worry prevents bad outcomes.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must either worry or be careless.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining worst-case outcomes repeatedly.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should feel anxious to prove I care.

Challenging questions

- Has worrying ever solved a money problem, or did actions solve it?

- What is the difference between worrying and planning?
- Who modeled money worry for me?
- What does Jesus say worry can add?
- What action steps could replace worry about this problem?
- What would it look like to pray and plan instead of worry?

Truth summary

> Worry is not the same as responsibility. Planning, budgeting, and acting are responsible, and I can do them with prayer and thanksgiving instead of anxiety. God's peace can guard my heart while I take wise steps.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anxiety/Worry
- Peace
- Thinking, Healthy
- Plans
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

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Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Worrying about money shows I'm being responsible"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Worrying about money shows I'm being responsible." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Has worry ever solved a money problem?
- ☐ What is the difference between worry and planning?
- ☐ Who modeled worry for me?
- ☐ What action can I take?
- ☐ What request can I bring to God?
- ☐ What am I thankful for?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Worry adds nothing to my life.
- ☐ Planning is responsible, worry is not.
- ☐ I can pray and plan.
- ☐ God's peace guards my heart and mind.
- ☐ I can cast my anxiety on Him.
- ☐ Today has enough trouble of its own.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Philippians 4:6–7
  "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Matthew 6:34
  "Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own."
- ☐ 1 Peter 5:7
  "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

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  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Worry to action: Each time you worry about money, write one action step you can take and one request you will bring to God.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Philippians 4:6–7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can pray and plan, and God's peace will guard my heart.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Anxiety/Worry" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

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- ☐ Set a worry time. Give yourself 15 minutes a day to think about money, then set it down.
- ☐ Write the action steps. Turn each worry into a specific task with a date.
- ☐ Pray with thanksgiving. Present one request to God and name one thing you are thankful for.
- ☐ Memorize Philippians 4:6–7. Say it when worry returns.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Worrying about money shows I'm being responsible": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

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Wed				
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My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Worrying about money shows I'm being responsible.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I confuse worry with responsibility. Teach me to plan wisely and to bring my requests to You with thanksgiving. Let Your peace guard my heart and mind. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.